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‘When I first entered the women’s cells after Kiran’s transfer,’ recalled Saroj, ‘I was met with a stunned silence. There is no better way I can describe it. No one was willing to speak anything and when overly cajoled and persuaded they would just mutter that it was alright.’ One of the women prisoners who related to her very well told her that foreign prisoners were now again being asked to get the ward authorities foreign goods through their visitors or else they would be given no privileges and life would be made difficult for them.

The word around the jail was that Ram Rajya had gone and Ravan Rajya had returned. One adolescent even went to the extent of telling her the next time he went to court for his trial he would make good his escape and would shoot the man who had transferred her. When reminded that would bring to naught all the efforts put in over the past two years, he apologized. He then said he would pray in prison that the concerned person met with a car accident and died or at least he would be demoted.

One could quite rightly claim that Tihar had come full circle and that soon all the earlier names it had earned for itself would be given back to it. Kiran had renamed Tihar Jail as Tihar Ashram, meaning a place of REFORM. After her transfer inmates renamed it as Tihar Anaath Ashram, meaning an orphanage …